

B1

GRAMMAR LESSON · PAST TENSES

Past Perfect vs Past Simple

Which past action happened first? Past perfect and past simple together.

İki Geçmiş Olayın Sıralaması

QUICK UNDERSTANDING

Bir cümlede iki geçmiş olay anlatılıyorsa, **hangisinin önce olduğunu** belirlemek zamanı seçer: daha önce olan olay Past Perfect (had + V3), ondan sonra olan (referans noktası) olay ise Past Simple ile kurulur. Zamanı yanlış seçmek olayların sırasını tersine çevirebilir.

The Structure

Formula

By the time + Past Simple, Subject + had + V3

Subject + had + V3 + before/after + Past Simple

Önce olan olay her zaman had + V3; sonraki referans olay Past Simple.

Affirmative / Negative / Question

AFFIRMATIVE

By the time + Past Simple, Subject + had + V3

By the time I woke up, he had left.

NEGATIVE

Subject + hadn't + V3 + by the time...

She hadn't eaten by the time we called.

QUESTION

Had + subject + V3 + by the time...?

Had you left by the time she arrived?

Word Order

by the time / before / after cümlecikleri başta veya sonda kullanılabilir; hangi eylemin önce olduğu had ile belirlenir, cümledeki sıralamayla değil.

- **By the time** he got to the station, the train **had** already **left**. — İstasyona vardığında tren çoktan kalkmıştı.
- She **had finished** her homework **before** her parents got home. — Ailesi eve gelmeden önce ödevini bitirmişti.

How It Works

When do we use it?

- **Hangi eylemin önce bittiğini netleştirmek için:** She had cooked dinner before her husband got home.
- **by the time ile bir sınır anına kadar tamamlanmış olayı vurgulamak için:** By the time we got to the theatre, the play had already started.
- **Neden-sonuç ilişkisini geçmişte sıralamak için:** He was exhausted because he had run a marathon that morning.
- **Sadece sıralı, art arda gelen olaylarda ikisini de Past Simple ile bırakmak için:** She opened the window and looked outside.

When DON'T we use it?

Sıralamayı belirsiz bırakmak için iki fiili de aynı zamanda KULLANMA — özellikle olayların sırası önemliyse biri Past Perfect, diğeri Past Simple olmalı.

✗ When she arrived, he left. (belirsiz: aynı anda mı, önce mi?) → ✓ When she arrived, he had already left. (o gelmeden önce gitmişti)

by the time'dan sonraki cümlede had'i unutm: ✗ By the time I finished, everyone left. → ✓ By the time I finished, everyone had left.

Short Answers

Past Perfect kısmına: Yes, I had. / No, I hadn't. — Past Simple kısmına: Yes, it did. / No, it didn't.

Not: Cümlelerin hangi fiiline soruluyorsa o fiilin zamanına göre kısa cevap verilir.

Türkçe Mantığı

Zihninde şu sırayla ilerle:

TÜRKÇEDE NE DEMEK İSTİYORUM? → "Sınav başlayana kadar hiçbir şey çalışmamıştım." → HANGİSİ ÖNCE, HANGİSİ SONRA? → çalışmamak (önce, sınavdan önceki süreç) — sınavın başlaması (sonra, referans nokta) → ÖNCEKİ → had + V3 / SONRAKİ (referans) → Past Simple → CÜMLE → "By the time the exam started, I hadn't studied anything."

Examples

BY THE TIME

- By the time the guests arrived, we had prepared everything. — Misafirler geldiğinde biz her şeyi hazırlamıştık.
- By the time I finished reading, it was midnight. — Okumayı bitirdiğimde gece yarısı olmuştu.
- By the time she called, I had already left the office. — O aradığında ben ofisten çoktan çıkmıştım.

WHICH HAPPENED FIRST

- He was tired because he had worked all night. — Yorgundu çünkü bütün gece çalışmıştı.
- Zeynep had already eaten when we invited her to lunch. — Onu öğle yemeğine davet ettiğimizde Zeynep zaten yemek yemişti.
- The film had already started when we got to the cinema. — Sinemaya vardığımızda film çoktan başlamıştı.

KARŞILAŞTIRMA

- She opened the door and saw the mess. — Kapıyı açtı ve dağınıklığı gördü. (aynı sırada, ikisi de Past Simple)
- She opened the door because someone had knocked. — Kapıyı açtı çünkü biri kapıyı çalmıştı. (had knocked önce oldu)
- Had you finished your homework by the time your mother came home? — Annen eve geldiğinde ödevini bitirmiş miydin?
- We hadn't packed our bags by the time the taxi arrived. — Taksi geldiğinde çantalarımızı hazırlamamıştık.

Compare & Notice

Compare With

Past Perfect	Past Simple
Cümledeki referans olaydan ÖNCE gerçekleşen. She had eaten before we called.	Cümledeki referans olay, ya da aynı anda/ardışık gerçekleşen olaylar. We called her at 8pm.

→ Past Perfect konusuna git

Visual Timeline

Timeline: Past Perfect: ilk olay (daha önce bitti) · Past Simple: ikinci olay (referans nokta)

Common Mistakes

✗ By the time I finished, everyone left.	✓ By the time I finished, everyone had left.
WHY? "by the time" ile referans olaydan (finished) önce tamamlanmış olay Past Perfect ile kurulmalı; iki fiili de Past Simple yapmak sırayı belirsizleştirir.	
✗ When she arrived, he left.	✓ When she arrived, he had already left.
WHY? İkisi de Past Simple olursa "aynı anda oldu" gibi algılanır; ama "he" onun gelişinden ÖNCE gittiyse had left kullanılmalı.	
✗ She had opened the door and saw the mess.	✓ She opened the door and saw the mess.
WHY? İki eylem aynı anda, ardışık olarak gerçekleşiyorsa (kapıyı açma ve görme) aralarında "önce/sonra" ilişkisi yoktur — ikisi de Past Simple kalır.	
✗ He was tired because he worked all night.	✓ He was tired because he had worked all night.
WHY? Yorgunluğun sebebi olan eylem, sonucundan (was tired) daha önce gerçekleştiği için Past Perfect ile ifade edilmelidir.	

Practice

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: _____ / 19

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. By the time I finished, everyone _____ .

a) had left

b) left

c) has left

d) leaves

2. Find the mistake and correct it.

She ^A had opened ^B the door and saw the mess. ^C

Correction: _____

3. He was tired because he _____ all night.

a) has worked

b) works

c) had work

d) had worked

PART B · PRACTICE

4. When she arrived, he _____ already _____ .

a) has / left

b) was / left

c) did / leave

d) had / left

5. By the time we got to the theatre, the play _____ . (start)

6. She _____ dinner before her husband got home.

a) has cooked

b) cooks

c) had cook

d) had cooked

7. Find the mistake and correct it.

By the time I finished, ^A everyone left ^B ^C.

Correction: _____

8. You arrive at the bus stop at 8:05. The bus left at 8:00.

What do you say?

a) The bus had already leave when I arrived.

b) The bus had already left when I arrived.

c) The bus already leaves when I arrived.

d) The bus has already left when I arrived.

9. "When I got home, my mum cooked dinner." What happened?

a) My mum started cooking after I got home.

b) Dinner was ready when I arrived.

c) My mum cooked before I got home.

d) Nobody cooked.

10. "When I got home, my mum had cooked dinner." What happened?

a) Nobody cooked.

b) I cooked dinner.

c) My mum started cooking after I arrived.

d) Dinner was ready when I arrived.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

11. I realised I _____ my wallet at home.

- a) had leave b) leave c) have left d) had left

12. She was upset because she _____ her driving test.

- a) had failed b) has failed c) fails d) had fail

13. They _____ (not / see) each other for years when they met again.

14. Find the mistake and correct it.

When the police arrived, the thief ^A has escaped ^{B C}.

Correction: _____

15. I _____ the book, so I knew the ending of the film.

- a) read tomorrow b) am reading c) had read d) have read

16. Your friend asks why you were nervous on the plane. It was your first flight.

Which answer is correct?

- a) I have never flown before then.
b) I had never fly before.
c) I never flew before tomorrow.
d) I had never flown before.

17. "The shop had closed when I got there." Could I buy anything?

- a) We can't know.
b) Yes — it closed after I left.
c) Yes — it was open.
d) No — it was already closed.

18. She _____ in Paris for five years before she moved to Rome.

- a) had live b) had lived c) has lived d) lives

19. Join with "by the time": "The guests left. Then we arrived."

By the time we arrived, _____ .

Answer Key

Kısa açıklamalar, her cevabın hangi kurala dayandığını gösterir.

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. a) **had left** — by the time + past simple → daha önce biten: had left.
2. B — **had opened** → **opened** — Art arda eylemler → past simple.
3. d) **had worked** — Yorgunluktan önceki sebep → had worked.

PART B · PRACTICE

4. d) **had / left** — Onun gelişinden önce → had already left.
5. **had started / had already started** — by the time → had + V3.
6. d) **had cooked** — Önce biten → had cooked.
7. B — **everyone left** → **everyone had left** — by the time ile önce biten → past perfect.
8. b) **The bus had already left when I arrived.** — Varıştan önce → had left.
9. a) **My mum started cooking after I got home.** — İki past simple → art arda: önce geldim, sonra pişirdi.
10. d) **Dinner was ready when I arrived.** — had cooked → gelmeden önce pişirmişti.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

11. d) **had left** — Fark etmeden önce → had left.
12. a) **had failed** — Üzülmeden önceki olay → had failed.
13. **hadn't seen / had not seen** — Karşılaşmadan önceki süre → hadn't seen.
14. B — **has escaped** → **had escaped** — Polisten önce → had escaped.
15. c) **had read** — Filmden önce okumuştum → had read.
16. d) **I had never flown before.** — O ana kadar deneyim → had never flown.
17. d) **No — it was already closed.** — had closed → varmadan önce kapanmıştı.
18. b) **had lived** — Taşınmadan önceki süre → had lived.
19. **By the time we arrived, the guests had left.** — by the time + past simple, past perfect.

Bu dersin interaktif versiyonu (anında geri bildirimli alıştırımlar):

<https://abonlinenglish.school/grammar/b1/past-perfect-vs-past-simple>